



Financial Clarity Made Simple

BRAND DESIGN SYSTEM

Visual Identity · UI/UX Guidelines · Component Library



1. Brand Overview



Financial Clarity Made Simple

1.1 About Budget IT

Budget IT is a personal finance and budgeting mobile application built with Flutter, designed to help individuals and households take full control of their money. The app combines real-time expense tracking, smart budget planning, and goal-based saving in an interface that feels effortless — regardless of the user's financial literacy level.

1.2 Mission Statement

"Financial Clarity Made Simple — empowering every person to understand, manage, and grow their money through beautiful, intuitive design."

1.3 Brand Personality

- Trustworthy — users share sensitive financial data; every decision reinforces security and reliability.
- Clear & Simple — complex finance becomes plain language and intuitive visuals. No jargon.
- Empowering — the brand celebrates milestones and never shames spending patterns.
- Natural & Grounded — the dark green / cream palette evokes growth, earth, and calm clarity.
- Modern — clean lines, generous spacing, and a rich dark aesthetic signal premium quality.

1.4 Target User

Primary: Millennials and Gen Z (22–38) who are employed or self-employed, tech-comfortable, and want better money habits without spreadsheets.

Secondary: Households and couples managing shared expenses, freelancers tracking variable income, and first-time earners building savings discipline.

1.5 Core Value Propositions

- Zero-effort expense capture with smart auto-categorisation
- Visual budgets — instant clarity on where money goes
- Goal-based savings — link saving targets to real life milestones
- Dual theme support — polished in both dark and light mode
- Weekly financial insights and personalised spending summaries

2. Logo & Visual Identity

2.1 Logo Mark

The Budget IT logo combines a stacked-coins illustration with an upward-trending blue arrow, symbolising financial growth and upward momentum. The icon sits above the wordmark on a neutral cream background in its default form.

2.2 Wordmark

The wordmark 'Budget IT' is set in a bold humanist sans-serif at display weight. The full name uses the dark forest green (#04240C) — the app's background colour — as the text fill on light surfaces, creating a strong typographic anchor. On dark surfaces the wordmark renders in cream (#DDD6AE).

2.3 Tagline

"Financial Clarity Made Simple" — the tagline appears below the wordmark on splash screens, onboarding flows, and marketing assets. It is set in medium weight, never bold.

2.4 Logo Usage Rules

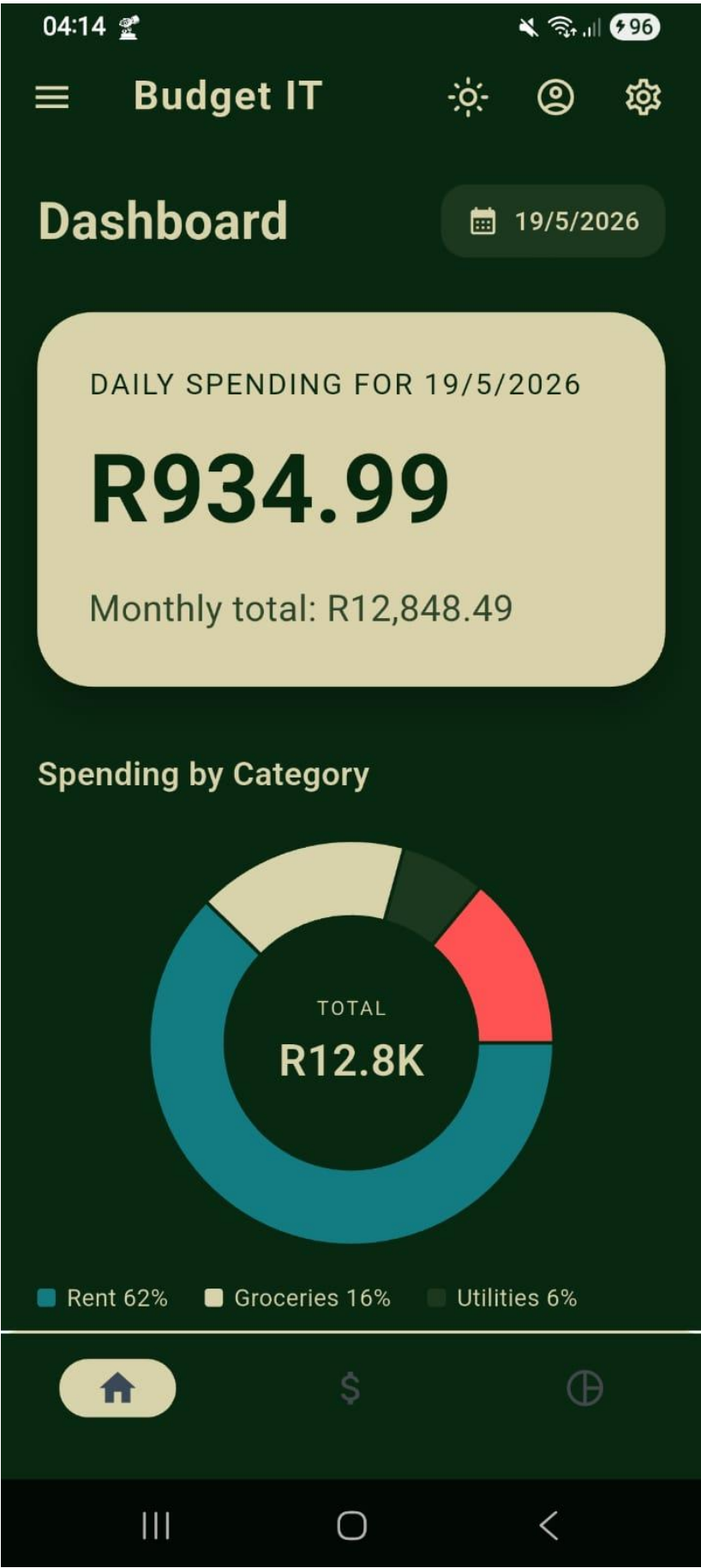
- Minimum clear space: equal to the cap-height of 'B' on all four sides
- Minimum screen size: 80px wide; minimum print size: 20mm wide
- On dark backgrounds (app screens): use cream wordmark with original icon
- On light backgrounds (marketing): use dark green wordmark with original icon
- Do not recolour the coin/arrow illustration — preserve original blues and golds
- Do not place the logo on busy photography without a solid colour overlay
- Do not stretch, rotate, or apply drop shadows to the wordmark

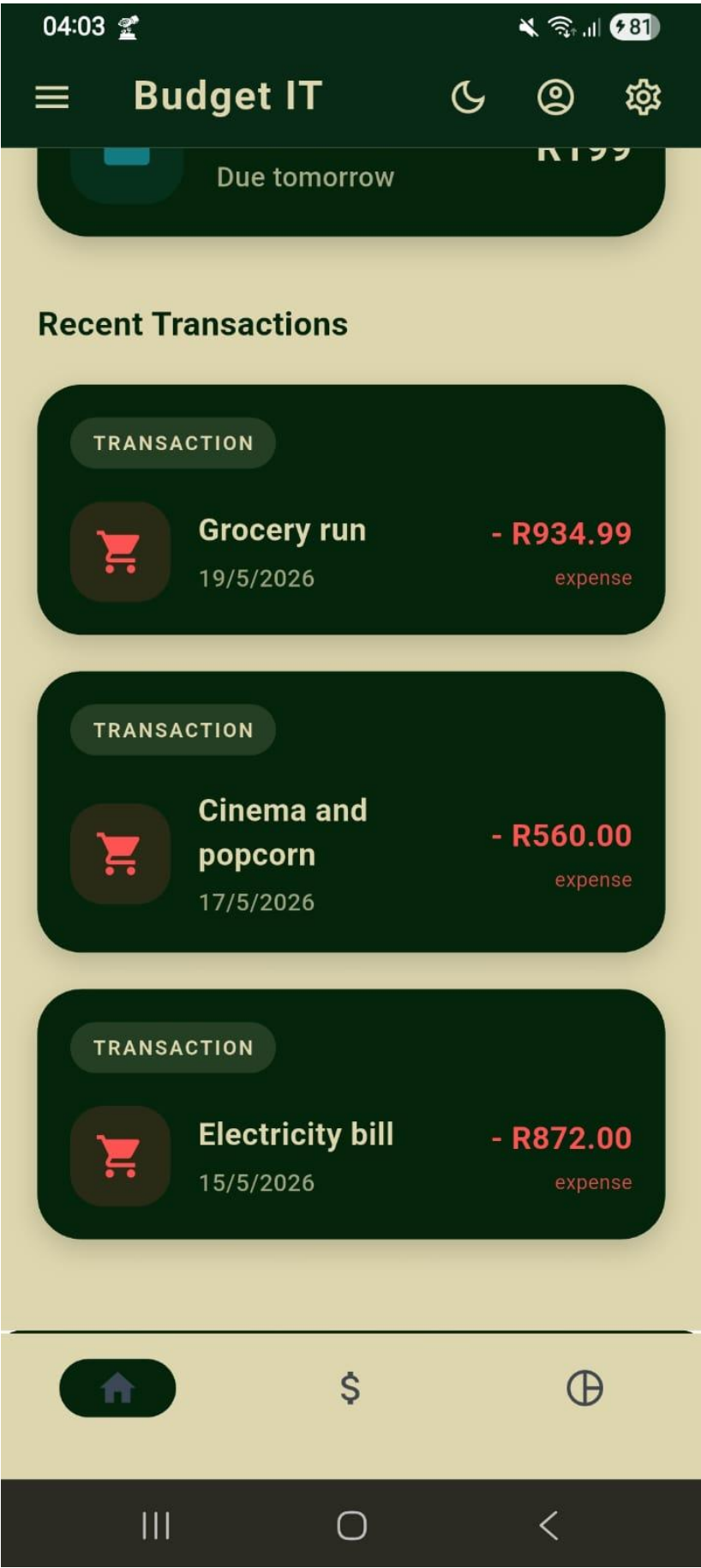
3. Colour System

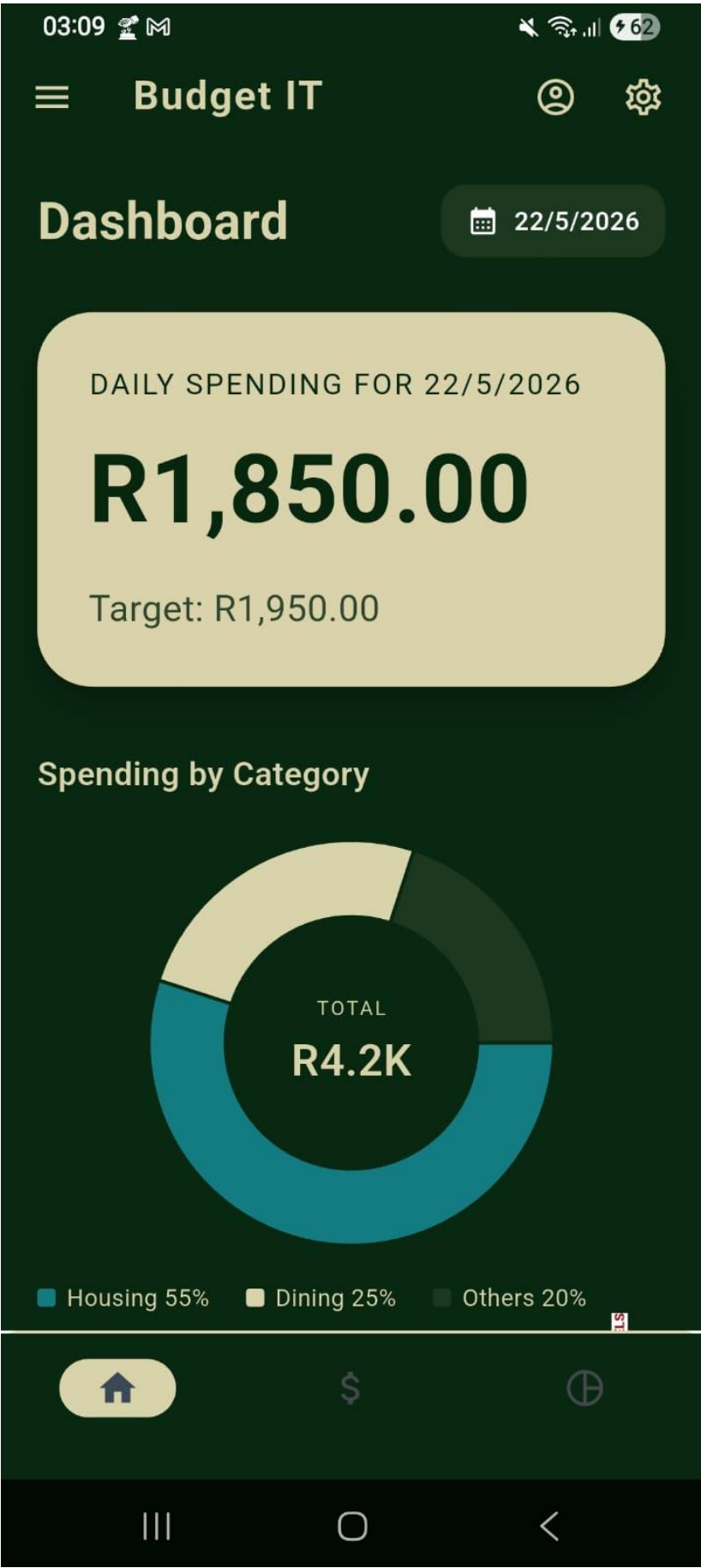
3.1 Full Brand Palette

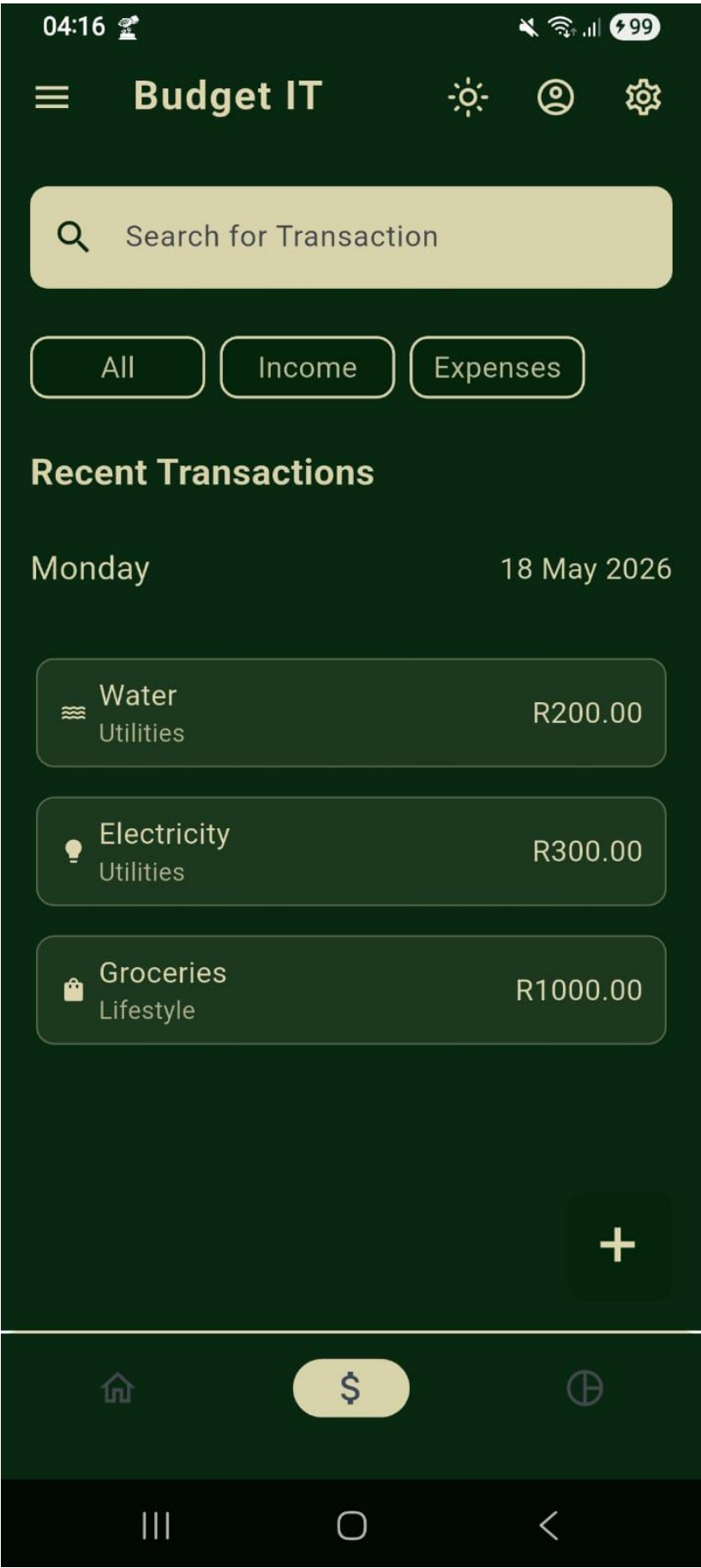
All colours are sourced directly from the Flutter MyColours class. The palette is intentionally minimal — a rich dark green as the structural base, warm cream as the primary text and UI surface colour, teal as the interactive accent, and two semantic colours (green and red) for financial states.

Swatch	Name / Hex	Role & Usage
	App Background #04240C	Dark mode screen fill, nav bar, structural chrome. fromARGB(250, 4, 36, 12)
	Cream / Secondary #DDD6AE	Primary text, card text, icons on green surfaces. fromARGB(250, 221, 214, 174)
	Teal / Tertiary #137E84	CTAs, active states, links, chart accents. fromARGB(250, 19, 126, 132)
	Green Accent #00E676	Positive balance indicators, income amounts, success states. fromARGB(255, 0, 230, 118)
	Cream Pale #F2EFE0	Section fills, card backgrounds, table alternates (light mode aligned)
	Cream Mid #CBC49F	Middle gradient stop — borders, dividers, secondary fills
	Warm Grey #77735E	Darkest gradient stop — body copy, captions, secondary labels
	Red #FF0000	Overspend, errors, failed states, negative deltas. fromARGB(255, 255, 0, 0)
	White #FFFFFF	White card surfaces, input backgrounds, modal backgrounds









3.2 Primary Gradient

The primaryGradient runs from top-left to bottom-right and is the default fill for all cards and primary surfaces in dark mode. It creates a warm, natural depth without harsh shadows.

Stop	ARGB	Hex	Role
Stop 1 (0%)	fromARGB(15, 221,214,174)	#DDD6AE @ 6%	Near-transparent cream — gradient start, top-left
Stop 2 (50%)	fromARGB(110, 203,196,159)	#CBC49F @ 43%	Mid cream — gradient body, primary card fill
Stop 3 (100%)	fromARGB(143, 119,115,94)	#77735E @ 56%	Warm grey — gradient end, bottom-right depth

3.3 Colour Usage Principles

- Use #04240C (dark green) for all structural chrome: backgrounds, nav bar, app bar.
- Use #DDD6AE (cream) for ALL text and icons placed on any green surface — no exceptions.
- Use #137E84 (teal) for interactive elements: active tabs, CTAs, focused inputs, links, chart highlights.
- Use #00E676 (green) exclusively for positive financial values: income, savings gains, under-budget indicators.
- Use #FF0000 (red) exclusively for negative financial values: expenses over limit, errors, failed states.
- Never place cream text on a cream background. Ensure minimum 4.5:1 contrast (WCAG AA).
- Do not introduce colours outside this palette without a design team review.

4. Theme Modes

4.1 Dark Mode (Default — isDark = true)

Dark mode is the primary, default experience for Budget IT. The dark forest green background (#04240C) is rich and distinctive, differentiating the app from competitors that default to white. Cream text provides strong contrast while maintaining warmth.

4.2 Light Mode (isDark = false)

Light mode inverts the background to cream and uses solid dark green for card fills and structural elements. The gradient in light mode transitions through three dark green shades. Cream text remains on all green surfaces via the cardText constant.

4.3 Mode Comparison

Property	Dark Mode (isDark = true)	Light Mode (isDark = false)
background	#04240C — dark forest green	#DDD6AE — cream/khaki
secondary	#DDD6AE — cream	#04240C — dark green
textPrimary	#DDD6AE — cream	#04240C — dark green
primary (solid)	#DDD6AE (23 alpha) — translucent	#04240C — solid dark green boxes
primaryGradient	Cream → mid-cream → warm grey	Dark green → mid green → forest
navBarColor	#04240C (background)	#04240C (secondary = dark green)
cardText	#DDD6AE — always cream	#DDD6AE — always cream
tertiary / teal	#137E84 — unchanged	#137E84 — unchanged
greenAccents	#00E676 — unchanged	#00E676 — unchanged
redColor	#FF0000 — unchanged	#FF0000 — unchanged

4.4 Theme Implementation Notes

- ThemeProvider controls isDark — all components read from MyColours(), never hardcode colours.
- navBarColor getter always returns dark green in both modes — nav bar never goes cream.
- cardText is a const (#DDD6AE) — it is ALWAYS cream regardless of mode. Never change this.
- tertiary (#137E84), greenAccents (#00E676), and redColor (#FF0000) are mode-invariant.
- When adding new components, test both modes before merging.

5. Typography

5.1 Font & Type Scale

Budget IT uses the system default font stack on both iOS and Android (San Francisco / Roboto respectively), ensuring native rendering quality. The type scale is defined directly in MyColours with three explicit heading sizes and a base body size.

Role	Size (Flutter)	Colour	Usage
Display / Hero	28–36pt	Cream #DDD6AE	Splash, onboarding hero, app name lockup
Heading 1	headingFontSize1 = 24pt	Cream #DDD6AE	Screen titles, major section headers
Heading 2	headingFontSize2 = 20pt	Teal #137E84	Card titles, sub-section headers
Heading 3	headingFontSize3 = 18pt	Cream #DDD6AE	List group headers, modal titles
Body Regular	bodyFontSize = 16pt	Warm Grey #77735E	Descriptions, labels, general copy
Body Small	14pt	Warm Grey #77735E	Hints, metadata, timestamps, captions
Amount / Number	20–24pt bold	Green #00E676 / Red #FF0000	Currency values — green income, red expense
Nav Labels	12pt	Cream #DDD6AE	Bottom nav bar labels, tab labels

5.2 Typography Rules

- Screen titles (Heading 1, 24pt) appear at the top of every screen — only one per screen.
- Card titles use Heading 2 (20pt, teal) to create clear hierarchy within cards.
- Body copy at 16pt is the floor — never render meaningful text below 14pt.
- All currency amounts must use the Amount style — never render financial figures in body weight.
- Positive amounts prefix with '+ R', negative with '– R' (en-dash, not hyphen).
- Sentence case throughout — avoid ALL CAPS except the logo lockup.

5.3 Currency & Number Formatting

- Default locale: South African Rand (ZAR) — prefix symbol R with a space: R 2 450.00
- Thousands separator: non-breaking thin space for ZAR locale

- Round to zero decimals when value is whole: R 2 450 (not R 2 450.00)
- Negative / over-budget: -R 120.50 in red (#FF0000) with warning icon

6. Spacing & Grid System

6.1 8-Point Base Grid

All spacing values are multiples of 4px with a preference for multiples of 8px. This creates consistent vertical rhythm across screens and aligns to Flutter's default layout geometry.

Token	Value	Usage
space-1	4px	Icon-to-label, hairline gaps, inline element spacing
space-2	8px	List item vertical padding, tag internal padding
space-3	12px	Input internal vertical padding, small card gaps
space-4	16px	Standard card padding (horizontal), button vertical padding
space-5	20px	Section vertical gap, screen horizontal gutter
space-6	24px	Between major sections, modal internal padding
space-8	32px	Hero breathing room, top-of-screen padding
radius-sm	6px	Chips, tags, badges, small buttons
radius-md	10px	Input fields, secondary buttons
radius-lg	14px	Modals, bottom sheets, list containers
radius-xl	16px	Cards — matches Flutter card radius on primary gradient cards
radius-fab	28px	FAB / primary CTA full-pill shape

6.2 Screen Layout Anatomy

- Horizontal gutters: 16px (space-4) minimum on all sides
- Top: respect device safe area — add 8px below status bar
- Bottom navigation bar: 60dp tall, 8dp icon-to-label gap, bg: `navBarColor (#04240C)`
- Cards: 16px internal horizontal padding, 14px vertical, gradient fill, 16px radius
- List rows: 12px vertical padding, 16px horizontal, `thinRule` dividers between items

6.3 Elevation & Depth

Budget IT achieves visual depth through the diagonal cream gradient on cards rather than heavy drop shadows. When shadows are needed:

- Card default: `BoxShadow(offset: Offset(0,4), blur: 16, color: rgba(0,0,0,0.25))`
- Modal / bottom sheet: `BoxShadow(offset: Offset(0,-4), blur: 24, color: rgba(0,0,0,0.35))`
- Avoid shadows on nav bar and app bar — use the background colour contrast instead

7. Component Library

7.1 Component Specifications

All specifications below derive directly from the Flutter MyColours definitions. Implement using the MyColours() instance — never hardcode a colour value in a widget file.

Component	State	Specification
Primary Button	Default	Background: primaryGradient (cream→warm grey), text: #04240C, radius: 12px, padding: 14×24px, bold
Primary Button	Pressed	Gradient darkens 15% — overlay rgba(4,36,12,0.15), no elevation
Primary Button	Disabled	Fill: #B8B299, text: #77735E, opacity 0.5
Secondary Button	Default	Border: 2px #137E84, text: #137E84, bg: transparent, radius: 12px
Text Input	Empty	Fill: #04240C (dark), border: 1px #1A4A22, text: #DDD6AE, radius: 8px, placeholder: #77735E
Text Input	Focused	Border: 2px #137E84, glow: rgba(19,126,132,0.25), label floats up in teal
Text Input	Error	Border: 2px #FF0000, error label below in red #FF0000
Card	Default	Fill: primaryGradient (diagonal), radius: 16px, shadow: 0 4px 16px rgba(0,0,0,0.25), text: #DDD6AE
Card	Light mode	Fill: solid #04240C, same radius & shadow, text: #DDD6AE
Budget Bar	Under budget	Track: #1A4A22, fill: #00E676 (green accent), radius: 4px
Budget Bar	80–99%	Fill: #DDD6AE (cream warning), track: #1A4A22
Budget Bar	Over 100%	Fill: #FF0000, pulse animation 800ms ease-in-out
Amount — Income	Any	Text: #00E676 bold, prefix: '+ R'
Amount — Expense	Any	Text: #FF0000 bold, prefix: '- R'
Bottom Nav Bar	bg	navBarColor = #04240C (dark mode & light mode)
Bottom Nav — Active	Tab	Icon + label: #DDD6AE, indicator: 2px #137E84 above icon
Bottom Nav — Inactive	Tab	Icon + label: #77735E
Toast — Success	Any	Fill: rgba(0,230,118,0.15), icon: #00E676, text: #DDD6AE, radius: 10px
Toast — Error	Any	Fill: rgba(255,0,0,0.15), icon: #FF0000, text: #DDD6AE, radius: 10px

Component	State	Specification
Toast — Info	Any	Fill: rgba(19,126,132,0.20), icon: #137E84, text: #DDD6AE, radius: 10px

7.2 Navigation

Budget IT uses a five-item bottom navigation bar as the primary wayfinding system:

- Home — dashboard: balance overview, spend ring, recent transactions
- Budget — monthly category allocation, limit vs actual, edit mode
- Add — raised FAB (pill button, primaryGradient fill) opens quick-add bottom sheet
- Goals — savings milestones, progress cards, celebration modals
- Profile — settings, linked accounts, theme toggle (dark/light), notifications

The Add tab uses a raised gradient pill (56dp height, radius-fab) elevated 4dp above the nav bar surface. It opens a DraggableScrollableSheet with three quick-add options.

7.3 Motion & Animation

- Page transitions: slide push 280ms ease-out
- Bottom sheets: spring curve 320ms, damping 0.8
- Budget bar fill: 600ms ease-out on screen mount — always animates from 0
- Goal completion: confetti burst 48fps, 1.2s, cream + teal + green particles
- Skeleton loaders replace spinners for any content taking >300ms to load
- All animations must honour Flutter's disableAnimations / Reduce Motion setting

8. Screen Design Patterns

8.1 Dashboard (Home)

The home screen delivers maximum insight with minimum cognitive load. Background: #04240C full bleed.

- Hero Card: total available balance — large amount in green (#00E676) on gradient card
- Spend Overview: donut chart, teal segments per category, cream centre label
- Top 3 Categories: horizontal scroll, gradient cards, icon + name + budget bar
- Recent Transactions: 5 rows, merchant name, category chip (teal bg), amount coloured
- FAB: always visible bottom-right, primaryGradient pill, '+' icon in #04240C

8.2 Budget Screen

- Month selector: cream chevrons on dark bg, current month bold in cream
- Summary donut: teal fill for spent, dark green track, cream centre text
- Category rows: icon (teal), name (cream), budget bar (green→cream→red), R amount
- Edit mode: tap row to inline-edit limit with number pad, confirm with teal button

8.3 Transactions

- Search bar: dark input field, teal focus ring, placeholder in warm grey
- Date group headers: cream bold on dark bg, thinRule below
- Row: merchant icon, title cream, category chip (teal), time warm grey, amount coloured
- Swipe left: red delete zone; swipe right: teal duplicate zone

8.4 Goals

- Goal card: gradient fill, emoji/illustration, cream title, green progress bar
- Projected date: warm grey small text below bar
- Milestone timeline: vertical line in teal, cream dot markers, date labels
- Completion modal: full-screen dark green, confetti, large cream celebration text

9. Accessibility Standards

9.1 Contrast

- Cream (#DDD6AE) on dark green (#04240C): contrast ratio 9.8:1 — exceeds WCAG AAA
- Teal (#137E84) on dark green (#04240C): contrast ratio 4.6:1 — passes WCAG AA
- Red (#FF0000) on dark green (#04240C): 5.2:1 — passes WCAG AA (large text)
- Never use warm grey (#77735E) alone on cream backgrounds — test before use
- All status must be conveyed by icon + colour together — never colour alone

9.2 Touch Targets

- Minimum: 44×44dp iOS / 48×48dp Android — enforced via Flutter GestureDetector padding
- Interactive elements must have 8dp separation from neighbouring targets
- FAB and primary CTA must remain above keyboard when open

9.3 Screen Readers & Dynamic Type

- All images have semanticLabel set in Flutter
- Chart widgets expose a textual data summary for screen readers
- All TextFields have explicit labelText — never rely on hintText alone
- Support textScaleFactor up to 2.0 without layout overflow
- Dynamic content (new transactions) wrapped in Semantics liveRegion: true

10. Voice & Tone

10.1 Brand Voice

Budget IT speaks like a financially savvy friend — knowledgeable without condescension, honest without shame. We celebrate wins and acknowledge shortfalls with care.

Principle	Write This	Not This
Clear	You spent R 320 on food this week.	Your alimentary expenditure totals R 320.
Encouraging	You're R 150 away from your goal!	You have only achieved 70% of your target.
Honest	You went R 80 over your dining budget.	Oops! Budget busted! 😬
Empowering	Adjust your budget anytime — no judgment.	You need to fix your spending habits.
Human	Nice one — you're on track this month!	Transaction processed successfully.

10.2 Microcopy Guidelines

- Button labels: verb-first, specific action — 'Add Expense', not 'Submit'
- Empty states: friendly, actionable — 'No transactions yet. Add your first one!'
- Error messages: explain what happened AND what to do — 'Amount required. Enter a value above R 0.'
- Success toasts: celebratory but brief — 'Saved!' / 'Expense added.'
- Onboarding: second person, present tense — 'Set your first budget in under a minute.'

11. Asset Management

11.1 File Naming Convention

All design assets follow this pattern:

[platform] [component] [variant] [state]@[scale].ext

- ios_btn_primary_default@2x.png
- android_icon_nav_home_active.svg
- all_logo_wordmark_dark.svg
- all_card_gradient_dark.png

11.2 Export Specifications

- Icons: SVG primary, PNG @1x/@2x/@3x fallback
- Illustrations / logo: SVG + PNG @3x for sharp rendering on high-DPI screens
- App icon master: 1024×1024px, auto-generate all platform sizes via flutter_launcher_icons
- Gradient fills: export as PNG asset (SVG gradient rendering is inconsistent across platforms)

11.3 Design Tool Stack

- Primary design: Figma — component library with auto layout and design tokens mirroring MyColours
- Prototyping: Figma Prototype + Lottie for animation previews
- Flutter integration: design tokens exported to a Dart constants file
- Version control: Git branches per feature; Figma branches for design work

12. Brand Do's & Don'ts

Do

- Use MyColours() instance for every colour in the codebase — never hardcode
- Always render text and icons on green surfaces in cream (#DDD6AE / cardText)
- Use teal (#137E84) as the single interactive / active-state colour
- Use green (#00E676) for income and positive states only
- Use red (#FF0000) for expenses and error states only — never decoratively

- Test all new screens in both dark and light mode before merging
- Celebrate user milestones — goal completion, first budget set, spending streak
- Write copy in sentence case, second person, plain English

Don't

- Don't hardcode any colour hex in widget files — always use MyColours()
- Don't use red or green for anything other than their designated financial meanings
- Don't place cream text on cream backgrounds — check contrast before every new screen
- Don't resize or recolour the coin/arrow illustration in the logo
- Don't use spinner indicators — use skeleton loaders for async content
- Don't introduce new brand colours without a design-team review and MyColours update
- Don't use ALL CAPS in UI copy — sentence case only, except the app name lockup

Budget IT Brand Design System

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